

EASTERN MEDITERRANEAN UNIVERSITY
COURSE OUTLINE
SPRING 2025

COURSE CODE	<i>PSIR 220</i>	COURSE LEVEL	<i>Undergraduate (BA)</i>
COURSE TITLE	<i>Research Design</i>		
COURSE TYPE	<i>Area Core</i>		
LECTURER(S)	<i>Erol Kaymak</i>		
CREDIT VALUE	<i>3 Credit Hrs.</i>	ECTS VALUE	<i>6</i>
PREREQUISITES	<i>None</i>		
COREQUISITES	<i>None</i>		
DURATION OF COURSE	<i>One semester</i>		

WEB LINKs

Moodle:
lmsmoddle

Email erol.kaymak@emu.edu.tr
Tel: (call Department) 630-1401
OFFICE HOURS Mondays 12:30-14:20, Tuesdays 10:30-11:20
(or by appointment) in BE 154
ASSISTANT N/A

CATALOGUE DESCRIPTION [need to cut and paste from catalog here]

AIMS & OBJECTIVES

This course is designed to provide an introduction to the use of quantitative methods in political science. We will cover a variety of topics, including research design and concept formation, measurement, and several techniques for assessing the relationships between variables.

GENERAL LEARNING OUTCOMES (COMPETENCES)

On successful completion of this course, all students will have developed **knowledge and understanding** of:

- The various choices and challenges faced by researchers when designing research
- The distinction between experimental and observatory research design
- Rudimentary understanding of social statistics
- Operationalization of variables
- Bi-variate research methods
- Multi-variate research methods
- Familiarity with submissions to the turnitin.com plagiarism detecting service

On successful completion of this course, all students will have developed **their skills** in:

- Analysis of secondary data
- Familiarity with different research design choices and the implications for inference
- Ability to put together a viable research proposal

On successful completion of this course, all students will have developed their appreciation of and respect for **values and attitudes** regarding the issues of:

- Research design selection based on appropriate level of analysis and aggregation
- Academic integrity in the research process
- Punctuality in the submission of work
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GRADING CRITERIA

"A" indicates excellent performance with clear evidence of:

- comprehensive knowledge of the subject matter and principles treated in the course,
- a high degree of originality and independence of thought,
- a superior ability to organize and analyze ideas, and
- an outstanding ability to communicate.

· "B" indicates good performance with evidence of:

- substantial knowledge of the subject matter,
- a moderate degree of originality and independence of thought,
- a good ability to organize and analyze ideas, and
- an ability to communicate clearly and fluently.

· "C" indicates satisfactory performance with evidence of:

- an acceptable grasp of the subject matter,
- some ability to organize and analyze ideas, and
- an ability to communicate adequately.

· "D" indicates minimally acceptable performance with evidence of:

- rudimentary knowledge of the subject matter,
- some evidence that organizational and analytical skills have been developed, but with significant weaknesses in some areas, and
- a significant weakness in the ability to communicate.

· "F" indicates failing performance with evidence of:

- an inadequate knowledge of the subject matter,
- failure to complete required work,
- an inability to organize and analyze ideas, and
- an inability to communicate.

RELATIONSHIP WITH OTHER COURSES

The course builds on rudimentary knowledge acquired at undergraduate level in IR and Pol Sci courses

LEARNING / TEACHING METHOD

Lectures, seminar discussion, research assignments.

METHOD OF ASSESSMENT

Midterm:	10%
Final:	20%
(Term paper) Assignments	60%
Participation/ <u>Exercises</u> /Attendance:	10%

Students are expected to read each article or chapter on the syllabus closely, and to come to class prepared to discuss and critique the readings. Additional requirements include:

1. Assignments (60%)

The course is designed to assist students produce a research paper through cumulative steps. It is imperative that students follow each step carefully, since only the successful completion of one step may lead to the next.

Each step is referred to as a 'recipe' (a cooking analogy employed in the Baglione text). Please follow the course outline to determine due dates for each step. In addition to 'recipes' each chapter finishes with a short number of exercises. These should also be attached to the recipe assignment when due.

Each recipe and associated exercise set is worth 7.5% of the final grade. There will be 8 recipes in all, which will correspond to a cumulative or aggregated grade worth 60% of the final grade.

Specific due dates will be posted on the turnitin.com website or Google Classroom. Instructions will be provided in class and elsewhere through the FBE moodle and on OneNote on how to register for the turnitin class online. The turnitin program will also specify rubrics per assignment and the instructor will discuss these in class and otherwise inform students on grading criteria.

2. Midterm (10%) and Final (20%)

There will be a midterm (10%) and a final (20%). The examinations will basically constitute a review of the materials covered in class and will entail some analytical essays. Details will be discussed in class.

3. Participation, Exercises and Attendance (10%)

In preparation for class, the instructor may discuss various exercises assigned in the course outline. Exercises will be posted as assignments in the LMS Moodle. Students are expected to come to class prepared to discuss assignments and otherwise do them in class where required. Details will be discussed by the instructor. post items of interest to seminar members, posting comments or posing questions. Most postings are cross-postings, meaning that I will make attempts to integrate the networks I work through, especially on the Google Classroom newsfeed.

~~.- Please make an attempt to respond to these comments or questions.~~

Attendance is compulsory by school regulations. Students are strongly advised not to miss lecture hours since success is closely related with attendance. Absences over 20% will be penalized with an NG. Bear in mind that attendance is not sufficient to achieve a high participation grade.

There is an online attendance system (attendance.emu.edu.tr). You will be able to monitor your attendance through your student portal. I will make an effort to take attendance at the beginning of each session. If you have a clash in your schedule, be sure to make this known to me so that I can accommodate you.

TEXTBOOK/S

Baglione, L. A. (2011). Writing a Research Paper in Political Science: A Practical Guide to Inquiry, Structure, and Methods.

Course notes, announcements, and readings can also be obtained online through the Moodle.

SEMESTER OFFERED

2025 Spring Semester

CONTENT & SCHEDULE

Lectures will be held on

Group1:
Mondays: 14:30-16:20 (BEA 2) and Wednesdays: 12:30-12:20 (CL 120)

The Schedule is as follows:

WEEK	DATE	TOPICS
<u>Date</u>	<u>CHAPTERS</u>	<u>TOPICS</u>
Week 1 24-26/02/25	No readings	Course introduction
Week 2 03-05/03/25	Preface and Baglione, Chapter 1	Introduction
Week 3 10-11/03/25 ⁱ	Baglione, Chapter 2	Research Question
Week 4 17-19/03/25	Continued	Recipe 1 Exercises 1 and 2
Week 5 24-26/03/25	Baglione, Chapter 3	Citations, Sources, References
Week 6 02/04/25	Continued	Recipe 2 Exercises 1 and 2
Week 7 07-09/04/25	Baglione, Chapter 4	Literature Review
Week 8 11-26/04/25	No Readings (midterms)	Midterm examinations
Week 9 28-30/04/25	Chapter 4 continued	Recipe 3 Exercises 1, 2 and 3
Week 10 05-07/05/25	Baglione, Chapter 5	Thesis, Model, Hypothesis Recipe 4 Exercises 1, 2, 3, and 4
Week 11 12-14/05/25	Baglione, Chapter 6	Revise and Edit Recipe 5 Exercises 1, 2, 3, and 4
Week 12 21/05/25	Baglione, Chapter 7	Research Design Recipe 6 Exercises 1, 2, 3, and 4
Week 13	Baglione, Chapter 8	Evaluation and Analysis

26-28/05/25	Baglione, Chapter 9	Recipe 7 Exercises 1, 2, and 3 Conclusion, Introduction, and Title Recipe 8 Exercises 1 and 2
Week 14 02-04/06/25		
Finals 11-25/06/25	Final examination period	Final examination (date to be determined)
